Taking a Stand in Liberty

Christ has set believers permanently and completely free from the Law; to add anything to that finished grace forfeits its profit, courts renewed bondage, and demeans the cross that purchased the freedom.

Where this study fits

Galatians · sixteen studies · this study highlighted

01 1:1–5 The Ground of Liberty	**02** 1:6–10 The One True Gospel	**03** 1:11–17 Paul's Independent Revelation	**04** 1:18–2:10 Paul's Gospel Is Independent of the Judean Churches
05 2:11–21 Peter Goes Back to School	**06** 3:1–5 Under a Spell	**07** 3:6–14 Blessing or a Curse	**08** 3:15–29 The Superiority of the Promise to the Law
09 4:1–11 When I Became a Man	**10** 4:12–20 A Steel Fist in a Velvet Glove	**11** 4:21–31 Paul's Old Testament Story	**12** 5:1–12 Taking a Stand in Liberty
13 5:13–26 Walk in the Spirit	**14** 6:1–5 Brothers and Burdens	**15** 6:6–10 Sowing and Reaping	**16** 6:11–18 Teaching the Truth

Stand fast — and don't be entangled again

Galatians 5:1 · Outline I — The request

The positive command — 5:1a
στήκετε Pres. Act. Impv. — keep standing

- “Stand fast therefore in the liberty by which Christ has made us free”
- Freedom already given (ἐλευθερία)
- Standing in it is a continuing choice

The negative command — 5:1b
ζυγῷ δουλείας yoke of bondage

- “Do not be entangled again”
- Gentiles: the yoke of pagan religion
- Jews: law-keeping to be accepted — now offered again

Freedom is a settled fact. Standing in it is an ongoing decision — it isn't automatic.

Three results of submitting to the law

Galatians 5:2–4 · Outline II — The results

A **Denied the power of Christ — v.2**
"If you become circumcised, Christ will profit you nothing"

περιτέμνησθε
subjunctive — not yet final

B **Indebted to keep the whole law — v.3**
All or nothing — no picking and choosing (cf. James 2:10)

ὀφειλέτης
a debtor

C **Detached from the grace of God — v.4**
Estranged in fellowship, off course from grace — not loss of salvation

ἐξεπέσατε
a ship driven off course

"Fallen from grace" — their relationship with God was not affected; their walk was.

The Spirit-filled alternative

Galatians 5:5–6 · Outline III — The reality of the Spirit-filled life

We patiently hope — v.5
ἀπεκδεχόμεθα eagerly, fully wait

- “Through the Spirit” — not the law's fast way
- Forward-leaning, patient expectancy
- “the hope of righteousness by faith”

We passionately love — v.6
ἐνεργουμένη δι' ἀγάπης working through love

- Neither circumcision nor uncircumcision avails anything
- Faith operates through love
- Serving Christ from love, not fear

Love, not fear, is the motive for serving Christ.

Five marks of the teachers of the law

Galatians 5:7–12 · Outline IV — Their reputation

v.7	They challenge the truth — “Who hindered you from obeying the truth?”	**ἐνέκοψεν** cut in on your lane
v.8	They are contrary to God — “This persuasion does not come from Him”	**πεισμονή** used only here in the NT
v.9	They contaminate the church — “A little leaven leavens the whole lump”	**ζύμη** small, but pervasive
v.10	Their conviction is certain — “he who troubles you shall bear his judgment”	judgment belongs to God
vv.11–12	They condemn teachers of the truth — the offense of the cross	**ἀποκόψονται** “cut themselves off”

Works that follow — and works that don't

Galatians 5:1–12 · Conclusion

	Works added to grace	The work of the Lord
Motive	To be accepted or kept by God	Love for Christ, who already paid
Reach	Limited to this life — no door out	Follows the believer beyond this life
Outcome	Christ profits you nothing (v.2)	Rewarded at the judgment seat of Christ

Add anything to salvation, and you demean the cross that purchased the freedom.

Discuss and apply

Galatians 5:1–12 · from the study's posted questions and applications

Discuss

1. The Galatians were told “just one small thing” needed adding to their faith. What “small things” do people quietly add to grace today?

2. How would you describe the difference between serving Christ out of love and serving out of fear or guilt (5:6)?

Apply

Resist the “Just One Small Thing”
Name one addition before God as unnecessary — not wrong to do, but adding nothing to what Christ finished.

Take Your Stand
Where you've been passively hoping to feel free, make one concrete, deliberate decision instead.

In one line: Christ has made us free — stand there, and add nothing to grace.